sovereigns must build an empire within the subcontinent and not outside. Thus, to many Indians, external entanglements hark back to the imperial outlook of the Raj instead of representing a genuinely swadeshi (home-made) world view.

Modern India has consistently been reluctant to involve itself in international conflicts and blocs though Nehru's non-alignment ideology was a way of being involved in the world without external commitments that would bind India to specific choices. India was trying to get the best of both worlds. Even now, India wants to be a permanent member of the UN Security Council without building the power potential possessed by other permanent members. For Indians influenced by isolationism, keeping India territorially intact, building a strong economy, eradicating poverty and creating a just society have often been more important than playing an active role in global conflicts or choosing between ideologies and blocs. While India wants to be considered a global power, not just a regional one, there are limits to which India will exercise its hard power.

India remains reluctant to send its troops abroad except for UN-mandated peacekeeping missions. The only wars India has fought have been within the subcontinent demonstrating that for India the subcontinent is still an extension of its civilizational homeland while the rest of the world remains too distant. This was true under Nehru and is true under Modi today, notwithstanding Modi's apparent desire to align India more closely with the United States and to create a grouping of Pacific powers aimed at containing China.

Of all India's prime ministers, Nehru best incorporated different strands of thought in defining India's global outlook. For that reason, Indian foreign policy has sometimes been referred to as *Nehruvian* – a combination of Messianic Idealism with some parts of Imperial, Realist, and Isolationist elements.